**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

**MGU-UGP (HONOURS) FOURTH SEMESTER EXAMINATION (2024 ADMISION ONWARDS) MG4DSCPSY201 – SELF and SOCIAL INTERACTIONS**

**Duration: 1.30 hrs** **Maximum Marks: 50**

**Course Outcome**:

**PART A Multiple choice questions – Answer all questions (1 mark each)**

1. Which description best captures the *nature* of social psychology as a discipline? CO1 U
   A It examines how people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by real, imagined, or implied presence of others
   B. It focuses only on large-scale social structures like institutions and economies
   C. It is primarily concerned with diagnosing and treating mental disorders in clinical settings
   D. It studies individual behavior in isolation from others
2. Which statement best captures social psychology's relationship with sociology? CO1 U
   A. Social psychology and sociology are identical, studying exactly the same units of analysis
   B. Sociology is a branch of social psychology
   C. Social psychology ignores social structures, while sociology ignores individuals
   D. Social psychology focuses on individuals in social contexts, while sociology often emphasizes groups and institutions, though there is overlap
3. Historically, which world events strongly shaped the development of social psychology as a discipline? CO1 R
   A. Global sporting events like the Olympics
   B. Technological innovations in agriculture
   C. World wars and social movements that raised questions about obedience, prejudice, and propaganda
   D. Discovery of new chemical elements
4. Which feature most clearly shows that social psychology is a science? CO1 U
   A. It depends on authority figures' opinions without question
   B. It avoids numbers and statistics in analyzing behavior
   C. It uses systematic observation, clearly defined variables, and replicable research designs
   D. It relies heavily on intuition and anecdotal stories
5. A schema in social cognition is best described as which of the following? CO2 R
   A. A fixed, permanent stereotype about a social group
   B. A random collection of facts stored in long-term memory
   C. A conscious list of rules we recite before making every decision
   D. A mental structure that organizes knowledge and guides processing of social information
6. Someone assumes a quiet, book-loving student is a librarian rather than a salesperson, ignoring the fact that sales jobs are much more common. Which heuristic explains this error? CO2 Ap
   A) Availability Heuristics B) Status Quo
   C) Representative heuristic D) Anchoring heuristic
7. Thinking one is better at a task than he/she actually is, is ---------- error CO2 Ap
   A) Overconfidence bias B) Planning Fallacy
   C) Optimistic bias D) Magical thinking

8. Which statement best defines an attitude in social psychology? CO2 U

A) A strictly behavioural habit with no emotional or cognitive components

B) A global evaluation of a person, object, or idea that can be positive, negative, or mixed

C) A momentary mood that shifts quickly

D) A stable personality trait that never changes

9. According to the elaboration likelihood model of persuasion, when are people most likely to follow the central route and carefully evaluate message arguments? CO2 U

A) When they automatically accept messages from authority figures regardless of content

B) When they have low motivation and low ability to process the message

C) When they are distracted and focused on peripheral cues like attractiveness

D) When they have high motivation and sufficient ability to process the message

10. In social psychology, which option best captures the definition of prosocial behaviour? CO3 R

A. Acts that reduce one's own distress, even if they harm others

B. Any behaviour that benefits others, regardless of the actor's motives

C. Behaviours that conform to social norms, whether or not they help others

D. Only actions that help others and are completely selfless with no personal gain

11. Which statement best distinguishes altruism from general prosocial behaviour in social psychology? CO3 E

A. Altruism refers to any behaviour that follows social norms, while prosocial behaviour is always selfless

B. Altruism is helping that occurs only in emergencies, while prosocial behaviour occurs in everyday situations

C. Altruism is prosocial behaviour motivated primarily by concern for another's welfare, not by expected personal gains

D. Altruism and prosocial behaviour are identical terms and have no meaningful difference

12. According to the empathy–altruism hypothesis, which motive is most central to truly altruistic helping? CO3 E

A. Fear of being punished for not helping

B. Desire to gain social approval from others

C. Empathic concern for the person in need

D. Wish to reduce one's own anxiety in the situation

13. Which sequence best reflects the classic five-step model of helping in emergencies by Latane and Darley? CO3 R

A. Assume responsibility → Notice the event → Interpret as emergency → Decide to help → Know how to help

B. Notice the event → Know how to help → Interpret as emergency → Assume responsibility → Decide to help

C. Notice the event → Interpret as emergency → Assume responsibility → Know how to help → Decide to help

D. Interpret as emergency → Notice the event → Assume responsibility → Know how to help → Decide to help

14. Which personal factor is most directly associated with consistently higher levels of prosocial behaviour across situations? CO3 R

A. Strong belief that the world is entirely fair

B. Frequently experiencing anger

C. High trait empathy for others

D. Low self-esteem in social situations

15. Which classroom activity would most directly aim at increasing students' prosocial behaviour toward strangers? CO3 Ap

A. Showing a neutral film unrelated to social issues or helping

B. Having students practice perspective-taking exercises where they imagine the feelings of people from different backgrounds

C. Instructing students to avoid interacting with people they do not already know

D. Assigning a multiple-choice test on definitions of prosocial behaviour and altruism

**(1 X15 =15 Marks )**

**PART B Short Essays – Answer any 5 questions (7 mark each)**

16. Explain the key characteristics of social psychology as a scientific discipline and how its emphasis on empirical methods distinguishes it from related fields like sociology and general psychology. CO1 R
17. Evaluate the interdisciplinary relations of social psychology with sociology, general psychology, personality psychology, and anthropology, determining which overlap is most vital for addressing contemporary social issues. CO1 E
18. Evaluate the strengths and limitations of terror management theory and optimistic bias as sources of error in social cognition. CO2 E
19. Apply the concepts of attitude components (ABC model) to a real-world scenario where an individual resists persuasion during a marketing campaign. CO2 Ap
20. Analyze how cognitive dissonance arises from spontaneous behavioural reactions conflicting with reasoned attitudes, and discuss the effectiveness of alternative resolution strategies like attitude change versus behavioural adjustment. CO2 Analyse
21. Explain the motives behind prosocial behaviour and outline the key steps individuals typically follow when responding to an emergency. CO3 R
22. Analyze how personal factors such as empathy-altruism and genetic/personality traits interact with situational enhancers like prosocial models, videogames, and norm activation to increase helping behavior toward similar others. CO3 Analyse

**(5 X7 =35 )**